Console Control

Quick reference — show automation for Allen & Heath dLive

Discrete cues on a timecode ruler, fired at the console through the dLive MIDI Bridge, programmed against your own show recordings. Every shortcut can be changed in View → Keyboard Shortcuts (Ctrl+Opt+K), and every button shows its key when you hover over it. The full manual is the **Reference Manual**, beside this guide in the download and at dylanmaudio.com/guides/console-control-reference-manual.pdf.

Transport & sync

Space / Ctrl+Opt+Space / Home	Play-stop / record armed reference tracks / go to start.
Left / Right	Move the playhead one snap step. 1…9 and 0 jump to regions 1…10 (Cmd+1…9: 11…19); G / Shift+G list the markers / regions; T asks for a timecode.
SYNC button	Next to record. SYNC **arms**, play **latches**, stop **disarms** — always. Dimmed = off · lit = armed · pulsing amber = awaiting code · green = locked · steady amber = freewheel. Click arms or disarms; right-click sets the source (LTC / MTC), inputs, freewheel, drift and offset.
[and]	Step the playhead through markers, region edges, audio clip edges and the project start.
Loop	Drag along the ruler's time row. Click the blue band to arm/disarm, double-click to clear. Wraps on the internal clock only.
Scrub	Grab the playhead line in the ruler; a plain ruler click locates.
View	Cmd+= / Cmd+– zoom, Cmd+0 fits the show, Cmd+Shift+0 the selection · Ctrl+Opt+Up / Down track height, Ctrl+Opt+F fits the tracks · Ctrl+Opt+G grid, Ctrl+Opt+M markers list.

Cues

Insert strip	U (unity) · –∞ (I) · V (value…) · M (mute) · slashed M (unmute, Shift+M) · S (scene…) · A (action…) — the keys are the letters on the buttons. Multi-selected tracks insert together, one undo step.
One selection	Click selects a cue · Cmd-click toggles more · a background drag's time selection selects everything it covers (its height picks the tracks; Cmd-drag adds).
Move	Drag any selected cue — the whole set moves with ghost previews. Scene/action cues drag by their small marker; the label text is not a click target.
Nudge	Opt+Left / Opt+Right by the amount selector: 1/5/10/25 frames, 1 second, or Beat × div.
Snap	Free · Frame · Grid (the lines you can see) · Beat (tempo grid at the note-value subdivision).
Tracks	Up / Down move to the previous / next track (Shift extends the selection) · L locks a track, Ctrl+Opt+L / Ctrl+Opt+U lock / unlock all · Opt+[/ Opt+] previous / next cue on the lane · Shift+S / Shift+A solo / arm a reference track.
Esc	Clears cue + time selection; a second Esc clears the loop. Also closes any dialog.

Fired vs pending

Plain readout	That value was actually transmitted to the console.
Dot on the readout	Resolved at the playhead but NOT sent (chase off, or moved without a conform).
Conform Console	Ctrl+Opt+C — transmits everything pending in one pass; usable live at any moment.
CHASE	Global button suspends all transmission (Shift+C); each lane's CHASE badge toggles that lane (C; applies across selected tracks).

Show day

Preflight (Ctrl+Opt+P)	Every before-doors check at once, with the exact reason anything fails.
Show Mode (Cmd+Shift+L)	Locks editing and undo. Huge timecode, sync, chase and bridge health, live track readouts — and what is coming next: the region you are in and its time left, then the next cues, markers and regions with countdowns (amber inside 10 s, red inside 3 s).
Panic (Cmd+Shift+Esc)	Always available, even in Show Mode.

Import a show recording

Import Audio (Cmd+I)	Up to 12 files. Roles are guessed from CONTENT: LTC / mix with embedded LTC / mix / click; chunked recordings (-001, -002…) join automatically.
Offline conform	Every span of continuous timecode is decoded and placed at its timecode — one clip per song on Mix and Click tracks, each outlined as a region.
Rate mismatch	The report offers “change the project to N fps and place” in one step.
Media	Files copy into the show bundle; 48 kHz copies are bit-identical.

Tempo & markers

Detect BPM	Select a click section → the tempo button → Detect. Each steady stretch gets its own tempo span, a ramp is followed beat by beat, and the grid is anchored ON the clicks; elsewhere is free time.
Markers	Opt+M at the playhead; Opt+Shift+M named. Lanes show/hide from the pills; double-click pills and labels on the ruler to edit.
Regions	Opt+R from the time selection; drag edges on the ruler; double-click to edit. Edit → Regions from Audio Clips outlines a track’s clips.
List panel	Editable markers / regions / tempo spans with per-lane colour.

Console data

Show-file import	File → Import Console Show File… (.tar.gz or Director CSV): scene NAMES (the only automated source), channel names + colours — matched by console address, cues untouched, one undo step.
Sync from Console (Ctrl+Opt+R)	Reads every channel’s name and colour from the desk through MIDI Bridge 1.1+, and shows what would change first; new channels can be added as tracks, nothing is deleted. One undo step.
Scenes / Actions	+ Track also creates extra Scenes tracks (independent categories) and Actions tracks (auto-claims the next CC). The gear on an action lane opens its configuration.

Reference audio

Mixer (Ctrl+Opt+X)	Gain, pan, mute, solo and arm per reference track, plus the master. Under each strip: **EQ** and **CMP** open that processor (the master has **LIM** as well); Shift- or Opt-click switches it in or out.
Processing	Each track: EQ → compressor → fader. Master: EQ → compressor → fader → limiter, whose threshold drives the mix into its ceiling. The EQ and compressor add no delay; the limiter adds 1.5 ms while it is in. Settings save with the show and are in every export.

Licence

Console Control menu → Licence…	Also on Settings → App: the state, a key field with **Activate**, **Deactivate this Mac**, **Buy…**. Read when a show is opened or created, never mid-session. Free tier = 5 cues of each type, all transmitting. A lapsed licence opens 3 more times with a warning, then output is off until renewed. The beta works in full until its date.

Check for updates

Console Control menu → Check for Updates…	Also on Settings → App. Manual only — never at launch, never on a timer — and refused while the transport runs, a chase is armed or the show is in Show Mode. Nothing is sent but the app's name and version.

Cue list mode

Settings → Sync → This show plays as	**Cue list**: the show runs on GO instead of the transport (saved with the show). Cues within 0.5 s after a marker fire as one GO; cues stacked on one time fire together; the rest one by one.
Keys	**Return** or **Space** GO · **Shift+Return** or **Shift+Space** Back (the console returns to before the moment) · **Cmd+Shift+G** Jump to… · Up / Down in Show Mode move standby · **Opt+Space** plays the timeline.
More	A marker can **auto-follow** (edit the marker: seconds to the next moment). **On GO** in Settings can play the reference audio from the moment. Companion has GO, Back, Jump and Standby, with the standing moment as a variable.

Latency

Calibrate… (Settings → Sync)	**Measure** times a round trip to the console through MIDI Bridge (→ console lead). **Read device** takes the LTC input's latency from CoreAudio (→ timecode arrives late by). **Check by ear** loops a click against a channel's mute: **Earlier / Later** nudge the lead, **Keep** saves.
Cues fire to the sample	Each cue is armed on a timer at its exact time, less the lead; Beat snap keeps the beat's exact time between frames.

Aux MIDI tracks

+ Track → Aux MIDI track	Cues to a plugin host or any MIDI device — SuperRack, LiveProfessor, a desk's MSC input. Each track sends to a **destination**: a virtual port the host sees as *Console Control - name*, or an existing MIDI output. Right-click the track for its lanes and destinations.
Lanes	**Single message** (PC with bank, CC, Note, MSC GO) · **Multi-message** (named states, as an Actions lane) · **Variable** (a CC the cues ramp) · **Piano** (notes with pitch, velocity, length) · **Echo** (follows a Scenes lane as Program Changes) · **Send BPM** (tap tempo and/or MIDI clock from the tempo map).
Learn	Press Learn in the host, then ■ on the lane — it sends the lane's message now. ■ in the Insert strip, **Opt+A**, or a double-click on the lane, inserts a cue. Piano lanes: the gear → **Open piano editor…** — click adds, drag moves, the right edge stretches, Delete removes, Up/Down transpose, Left/Right nudge.

Output

Export Audio (Cmd+E)	Stereo or mono master with LTC, master and LTC in one file, master only, or every reference track — over the selection, one region, or every region with audio. WAV 44.1–96 kHz at 16/24/32-bit, timestamped, or MP3.
Recording	Armed tracks capture to <Track>-001.wav (incrementing) at the timeline position.
Save guard	Close / New / Open / Open Recent / RPP import all warn before discarding changes; autosave interval in Settings.

The bridge line (bottom of the window)

Green	Console connected through the dLive MIDI Bridge (IP shown).
Amber	Bridge running, console unreachable — check the console IP in the bridge, the network, and MIDI-over-TCP on the console.
Red	Start the dLive MIDI Bridge app.

Console Control never opens its own console connection — the bridge owns the console's single MIDI-over-TCP socket.

If something goes wrong

Export log	Click **Export log** in the panel footer. A diagnostics zip lands on your Desktop — this session's log, the previous one, and your settings. Send that zip with your report; nothing leaves your Mac unless you send it.
What the log holds	Your settings at launch and each change, the audio device and its buffer size, the show opened, saved and autosaved, every timecode lock and loss, every Conform, the bridge link and why it could not open, every message the app showed you. Every launch is logged automatically to **~/Library/Logs/dylanmaudio/Console Control/**; newest 20 launches kept.
Send feedback	Also in the footer — a short message straight to me, no email client needed.

What's new in v0.3.2

• Fixed: on macOS 12 and 13, after inserting a scene (S, pick, Return) the next S did nothing until something else was clicked: the scene list kept the keyboard inside the closed dialog. Keyboard focus now leaves every dialog as it closes.
• Fixed: if the Mac's audio system reset while a take was recording, the app kept saying REC while nothing was being written, and the take never reached the show. The take now ends with the audio restart, its files are kept and added to the show, and a notice says to press Record for a new one. And after a restart while chasing, the app waits for the code to lock before it reads as playing, as Play does.
• Fixed: while MIDI Bridge was disconnected or reconnecting (a flaky console network), the playhead froze and jumped and cues fired late: the app was waiting on the bridge from the thread that keeps time. It now reconnects and reads the bridge's status in the background, so a console network can never stall playback. Cues sent while the bridge is down are still lost, as before; the console link line says so.
• Fixed: a scene recall (or any cue) could now and then be sent to the console twice, a few milliseconds apart, most often on a slower Mac. Each cue is now sent once.
• Fixed: chasing a timecode source that stopped and came back at a different frame rate (25 to 30 fps, say) could show "Timecode is running slow — check the playback device's sample rate" when nothing was slow. That warning now waits for a few seconds of steady code.